

4.5 Editing and Modifying Software

Ever wondered why any video that is shot badly is termed to be of ‘home video quality’? Well, it’s because most home videos are of very bad quality. It’s not just the way a video is shot, but also the way it is edited, and effects such as background music, use of ambient sound and visual effects that makes a video look good.

An unedited video is at best a collection of shots. To get the effect of a continuous movie, one of the most important things is to cut and chop at the right places, do away with unwanted footage and add some spunk to the required footage by means of special effects or audio tracks. Editing a video does require some amount of expertise in the handling of the software, and also in understanding the logical sequence of the shots you’ve taken and translate that idea while editing the video. Trying to edit your videos on the fly will only lead to poor output, especially if you’re a novice.

After shooting the footage for your video and compressing the file so it doesn’t eat up swathes of space on your hard disk, you would need an editing suite or footage processing tool to work the magic. Video editing software handles the editing of video sequences. This includes the ability to import and export video, cut and paste sections of a video clip, and add special effects and transitions. Newer versions of such software also include the ability to encode the video so you can create your own DVD. Editing software also allow editing of the audio clips that accompany the video. They also have the capability to sync the audio with the video.

Editing is primarily done in two ways: linear editing, where the entire file is treated as one unit, and non-linear editing - where each frame can be treated as a separate object. All high-end editing suites are non-linear editors, as precision editing requires you to treat each frame separately. This also makes the process of adding special effects and extra audio tracks easier, since you determine the exact instant when an audio track should play or an effect should appear.